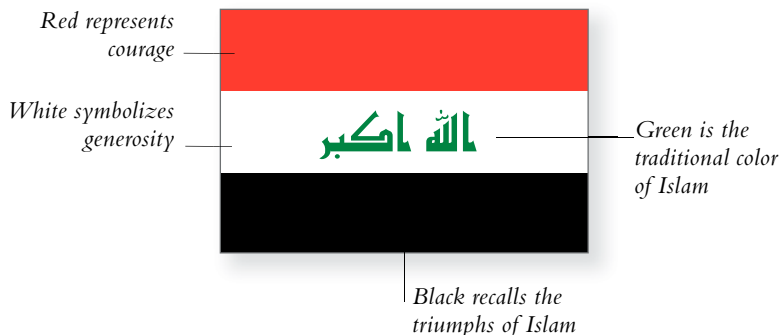


Iraq

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 19, 2008 **Usage:** National and Civil



Asia



Iraq has been independent since 1932. The republic was proclaimed in 1958. Period of instability since 2003, following the overthrow of Saddam Hussein.

The flags of Iraq have always included the pan-Arab colors of red, white, black, and green. The colors represent the qualities of those who follow Islam. Red represents courage; white stands for generosity; black is for the triumphs of Islam, and green is for Islam itself.

Three green stars were added to the flag in 1963, based on the then

flag of Egypt (see page 60). In 1991, the inscription was added. It was modified and the stars removed in 2008.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

Also in 1963 the golden Eagle of Saladin became the national arms. It always shows the national flag on its chest.

ISLAMIC VERSE

The Islamic verse was added to the flag in 1991 and modified in 2004 and 2008



The takbir reads "Allahu Akbar" ("God is Great")